IELTS FOUNDATION · UNIT 9

Language

How we learn languages, our plans and a longer talk

Vocabulary | Grammar | Reading | Listening | Writing | Speaking

Mindset for IELTS Foundation · Unit 9 · Book pp. 103–113

LEARNING GOAL

Talk about how you learn languages, make plans and give a longer talk

Objectives: you will...

- use words for communicating with other people
- use going to and adverbs of time for future plans
- listen to a discussion about a language project
- give a longer talk about a topic
- use collocations
- skim an article and write a short essay

Success criteria: I can...

- use the right preposition: talk to, chat about, by email
- make plans with am / is / are + going to
- prepare notes in one minute and use them
- say a paragraph’s main idea in fewer words
- keep to a word limit
- organise an essay in four paragraphs

IELTS STRATEGIES

Test habits to build in this unit

SPEAKING

Longer talk: **one minute** to prepare and **make notes**; use your notes as you talk.

box, p. 106

VOCABULARY

Use **collocations**: have a cup of tea, not take a cup of tea.

Tip 15, p. 106

READING

Each paragraph has **one main idea**. Say it in fewer words.

Tip 17, p. 107

READING

Sentence completion: **paraphrase** and keep to the **word limit**.

Tip 20, p. 108

LEAD-IN

How do you learn English?

- use a dictionary
- keep a vocabulary notebook
- listen to songs in English
- watch videos online

Which ways of learning English work best for you? Why?

VOCABULARY AND SPEAKING

Communication words

talk

talk **to** / **with** someone · talk **about** something

chat

chat **with** someone · chat **about** something

communicate

communicate **by** email / phone

discuss

discuss **the topic** (no preposition!)

Ask a partner: “How often do you talk to people on the internet?”

GRAMMAR · GOING TO FOR FUTURE PLANS

I’m going to…

	person + be	going to	verb
Plan	I am / She is	(not) going to	learn five new phrases.
Question	Are you / Is he	going to	video call his cousin later?
Wh- question	Where are you	going to	go to university?

Tip 07, p. 104

Adverbs of time (*next week, tomorrow, later*) usually go at the **end** of the sentence.

Tip 10, p. 105

People often say **gonna** in everyday speech. Never write it in formal English.

GRAMMAR · COMMON MISTAKES

Find the mistake

× Mistake	✓ Correct	Why
I **going to** study tonight.	I **am going to** study tonight.	am / is / are is needed
She is going to **visits** Seoul.	She is going to **visit** Seoul.	base verb after going to
Do you going to learn Spanish?	**Are you going to** learn Spanish?	question: Are + you
I'm going to start **yesterday**.	I'm going to start **tomorrow**.	future time words
In this essay, I'm **gonna** discuss…	In this essay, I am **going to** discuss…	gonna is informal



Find the mistake, say the rule, then write the correct sentence.

LISTENING · DISCUSSING A LANGUAGE PROJECT

Who, where and what next?

Sofia and Oliver plan a language project.

Listen: **True** or **False**?

Listen again: complete the table with each teacher’s **room**.

Where is Sofia going to go next?

Listen for corrections

“It isn’t B21, it’s B12.” “Not Thursday, Friday.” The **second** answer is often the right one.

SPEAKING · A LONGER TALK ABOUT A TOPIC

One minute to plan, two minutes to talk

Describe a language you are studying. You should say:

- what the language is
- how well you know it
- how long you are going to study it

and explain why you are learning it.

IELTS STRATEGY

You have **one minute** to prepare and **make notes**.

Use your notes to help you while you talk.

VOCABULARY · COLLOCATIONS

Words that go together

make

a mistake · an effort · progress · a difference

have

a cup of tea · fun · an advantage · a chat

hold / take

hold a conversation · take an exam · take a picture

IELTS STRATEGY Say **have** a cup of tea, not *take* a cup of tea. Collocations are vocabulary, not grammar.

READING · SKIMMING AND MAIN IDEAS

One paragraph, one main idea

Skim the article **Multilingual**: Who is Richard? What is special about him?

For each paragraph, ask: what is it **mostly** about?

Say it in **one sentence**, in fewer words.

IELTS STRATEGY

Most paragraphs have **one main idea**.

Think about what the writer wants to say, then summarise it in **fewer words**.

READING · SENTENCE COMPLETION

NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS

Text: “Ana uses a free app to learn new words.”

Ana learns new words with a **free app**. ✓ 2 words

Ana learns new words with **an app that is free**. × 5 words

Ana learns new words with a **notebook**. × wrong meaning

IELTS STRATEGY The sentence **paraphrases** the text. Count your words: more than the limit loses marks.

WRITING · A SHORT ESSAY ON A TOPIC

Four paragraphs

1 · Introduction

In this essay, I am going to discuss…

2 · Advantages

Firstly, … Additionally, …

3 · Disadvantages

On the other hand, … Furthermore, …

4 · Conclusion

To sum up, … In my opinion, …

Each paragraph = **one main idea.** Organise with **words in bold** like the model.

WRITING · YOUR ESSAY

Plan, then write 220–250 words

Essay question: What are the advantages and disadvantages of taking English lessons with classmates from the same country?

Plan: two advantages · two disadvantages · your opinion

Use: *Firstly, Additionally, On the other hand, Furthermore, To sum up*

Check: no *gonna* · capital letters · paragraphs

Read the **Model answer** on p. 110 after you write. What did it do that you didn’t?

PAIR PRACTICE

Your turn, together

Student A

Talk for two minutes: describe a language you are learning. Say what it is, how well you know it and why you are learning it.

Student B

Talk for two minutes: describe a skill you are going to learn. Say what it is, how you are going to learn it and why.

One minute to make notes. Use your notes while you talk. Your partner asks one question at the end.

REVIEW

Can you…?

- ✓ use talk to, chat about, by email, discuss
- ✓ make plans with going to
- ✓ use make / have / take collocations
- ✓ find a paragraph’s main idea
- ✓ keep to a word limit
- ✓ plan and give a longer talk

Next: the Unit 9 Challenge on the Miss L Gems site.